

**NEXGEN SOLUTIONS INC.**

*Building Tomorrow's Workforce Today*

# EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

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*Your Complete Guide to Policies, Benefits & Procedures*

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**Effective Date: January 1, 2025**

Version 3.0 | Human Resources Department

**Confidential — For Internal Use Only**

# Table of Contents

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# Welcome to NexGen Solutions

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**Dear Team Member,**

On behalf of everyone at NexGen Solutions Inc., welcome! We are thrilled to have you join our growing family of innovators, problem-solvers, and dedicated professionals. This handbook is your essential companion as you navigate life at NexGen.

At NexGen, we believe our people are our most valuable asset. We have built a culture rooted in respect, inclusion, continuous learning, and shared success. Whether you are joining us fresh out of school or bringing decades of experience, you will find a place where your contributions matter and your growth is supported.

This handbook outlines the policies, benefits, and procedures that govern our workplace. Please read it thoroughly — understanding these guidelines will help you thrive here. It is not a contract of employment, but it is our commitment to transparency and fairness.

We encourage you to ask questions, seek feedback, and actively participate in our culture. Our doors — and inboxes — are always open.

*With excitement and warmth,*

**Alexandra Reid**

Chief Executive Officer, NexGen Solutions Inc.

CHAPTER 01

HR Policies

The foundation of a fair and respectful workplace

1.1 Equal Employment Opportunity

NexGen Solutions Inc. is an Equal Opportunity Employer. We do not discriminate on the basis of race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, veteran status, or any other characteristic protected by applicable federal, state, or local law.

All employment decisions — including recruitment, hiring, promotion, compensation, benefits, training, discipline, and termination — are made without regard to any protected characteristic. Our commitment extends to all phases of employment and to all employees, contractors, and applicants.

1.2 Anti-Harassment & Anti-Discrimination Policy

NexGen maintains a strict zero-tolerance policy for harassment, discrimination, and bullying. This includes:

- Sexual harassment — unwanted advances, requests for sexual favors, or verbal/physical conduct of a sexual nature
- Verbal harassment — offensive jokes, slurs, threats, epithets, or teasing based on protected characteristics
- Physical harassment — unwanted touching, blocking movement, or physical interference with work
- Visual harassment — displaying offensive posters, cartoons, drawings, symbols, or gestures
- Cyberbullying — harassment through digital platforms including email, chat, or social media



Reporting Procedure

Step 1: Report to your direct manager or HR Business Partner immediately.

Step 2: If your manager is involved, escalate directly to the HR Director.

Step 3: File a formal written complaint with HR within 10 business days.

Step 4: An independent investigation will be launched within 5 business days.

Step 5: Retaliation against reporters is strictly prohibited and itself grounds for termination.

Anonymous Hotline: 1-800-NGS-SAFE (available 24/7)

1.3 Code of Conduct

All employees are expected to conduct themselves with the highest degree of professionalism, honesty, and integrity. The following standards apply at all times during work hours and at company-sponsored events:

1. Treat all colleagues, clients, vendors, and visitors with courtesy and respect.

- 2. Maintain confidentiality of proprietary business information, client data, and trade secrets.
- 3. Avoid actual or perceived conflicts of interest and disclose any potential conflicts to HR.
- 4. Use company resources (equipment, systems, supplies, time) responsibly and only for authorized business purposes.
- 5. Comply with all applicable laws, regulations, and company policies at all times.
- 6. Represent NexGen professionally in public, on social media, and in all external communications.
- 7. Report suspected violations of law, policy, or ethics through appropriate channels without fear of retaliation.

1.4 Attendance & Punctuality

Reliable attendance is fundamental to team success and customer satisfaction. Employees are expected to:

- Arrive on time and be ready to work at their designated start time
- Notify their manager at least 1 hour before shift start when unable to attend
- Maintain an absence rate below 3% of scheduled working days per quarter
- Return from meal and rest breaks promptly

| Occurrence            | Action Taken                                     |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| 1st Unexcused Absence | Verbal warning documented in HR file             |
| 2nd Unexcused Absence | Written warning within 30-day period             |
| 3rd Unexcused Absence | Final written warning & performance plan         |
| 4th Unexcused Absence | Subject to disciplinary action up to termination |
| Habitual Tardiness    | Three late arrivals = one unexcused absence      |

1.5 Performance Management

NexGen operates a structured, continuous performance management cycle designed to align individual contributions with organizational goals.

| Period                | Milestone         | Description                                                  |
|-----------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Q1 (January–March)    | Goal Setting      | Employees & managers co-create SMART goals for the year      |
| Q2 (April–June)       | Mid-Year Check-In | Informal review of progress; goals may be adjusted           |
| Q3 (July–September)   | 360° Feedback     | Peers, reports, and stakeholders provide structured feedback |
| Q4 (October–December) | Annual Review     | Formal assessment, ratings, compensation discussions         |

Performance ratings are on a 5-point scale: 1 = Significantly Below Expectations, 2 = Below Expectations, 3 = Meets Expectations, 4 = Exceeds Expectations, 5 = Outstanding. Ratings directly influence merit increases, promotions, and bonus eligibility.

1.6 Disciplinary Policy

NexGen follows a progressive discipline framework. Depending on the severity of the offense, steps may be skipped. Certain violations (e.g., fraud, violence, data theft) may result in immediate termination.

| Step   | Action                                                  |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Step 1 | Verbal counseling — documented in employee file         |
| Step 2 | Written warning with corrective action plan             |
| Step 3 | Final written warning (possible suspension without pay) |
| Step 4 | Termination of employment                               |

1.7 Workplace Diversity & Inclusion

NexGen is committed to building and sustaining a diverse, equitable, and inclusive workplace. Our D&I initiatives include:

- Annual unconscious bias training for all employees and managers
- Employee Resource Groups (ERGs) for Women in Tech, LGBTQ+ Pride, Veterans, and Multicultural Professionals
- Diverse candidate slates required for all senior-level hiring
- Pay equity audits conducted annually by an independent third party
- D&I metrics published in our annual Corporate Responsibility Report

|                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  <b>Key HR Contacts</b> |
| HR Director: Sandra Okafor   sandra.okafor@nexgen.com   Ext. 4400                                          |
| HR Business Partner (Tech): David Yuen   david.yuen@nexgen.com   Ext. 4410                                 |
| HR Business Partner (Operations): Lisa Park   lisa.park@nexgen.com   Ext. 4420                             |
| Employee Relations: Marcus Webb   marcus.webb@nexgen.com   Ext. 4430                                       |
| HR Helpdesk: hr@nexgen.com   Ext. 4000 (Mon–Fri, 8 AM–6 PM)                                                |

CHAPTER 02

Leave Policies

Time away to rest, recover, and recharge

2.1 Annual (Vacation) Leave

NexGen believes in work-life balance. All full-time employees accrue paid vacation leave based on length of service:

| Tenure       | Annual Entitlement  | Notes                                 |
|--------------|---------------------|---------------------------------------|
| 0 – 2 years  | 10 days (80 hours)  | Accrual begins after 90-day probation |
| 2 – 5 years  | 15 days (120 hours) | Auto-upgraded on work anniversary     |
| 5 – 10 years | 20 days (160 hours) | Auto-upgraded on work anniversary     |
| 10+ years    | 25 days (200 hours) | Maximum accrual tier                  |

- Leave requests must be submitted in Workday at least 5 business days in advance (14 days for requests ≥ 5 consecutive days).
- Maximum accrual carry-over: 5 days (40 hours) to the next calendar year. Excess is forfeited on January 31.
- Vacation payout upon separation: accrued, unused leave is paid out at the employee's current base hourly rate.
- Vacation during notice period requires prior written approval from HR.

2.2 Sick Leave

NexGen provides paid sick leave to support employees during personal illness or medical appointments. Sick leave may not be borrowed against future accrual.

| Policy Item    | Detail                                                                                              |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Accrual Rate   | 1.5 days (12 hours) per month, up to 18 days (144 hours) per year                                   |
| Carry-Over     | Up to 10 days may carry over annually                                                               |
| Waiting Period | Available immediately upon hire (no probation restriction)                                          |
| Certification  | Medical certificate required for absences exceeding 3 consecutive days                              |
| Permitted Uses | Personal illness, injury, preventive care, mental health, caring for an ill immediate family member |

### 2.3 Parental Leave

NexGen supports new parents with generous paid parental leave applicable to birth, adoption, and foster placement.

| Leave Type            | Entitlement                                                      |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary Caregiver     | 16 weeks fully paid leave                                        |
| Secondary Caregiver   | 6 weeks fully paid leave                                         |
| Adoption / Foster     | Same entitlements as biological birth (primary/secondary)        |
| Eligibility           | Employed for at least 12 months prior to leave start             |
| Flexible Return       | Option to return on a 50% schedule for up to 4 weeks at full pay |
| Job Protection        | Your role (or equivalent) is guaranteed upon return              |
| Benefits Continuation | All benefits continue during parental leave                      |



#### Parental Leave Tips

Notify HR and your manager at least 30 days before planned leave start date.

Coordinate a handover plan with your team at least 2 weeks before departure.

Stay connected optionally — we never require contact during leave.

Contact HR for help coordinating government parental benefits where applicable.

### 2.4 Bereavement Leave

| Relationship                         | Paid Leave                                            |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Spouse / Domestic Partner / Child    | 5 days fully paid                                     |
| Parent / Sibling / Grandparent       | 3 days fully paid                                     |
| In-Laws / Grandchildren / Aunt/Uncle | 2 days fully paid                                     |
| Close Friend or Extended Family      | 1 day paid (manager discretion for additional unpaid) |
| Pregnancy Loss                       | Up to 3 days fully paid, additional leave available   |



## 2.5 Other Leave Types

| Leave Type                   | Entitlement & Conditions                                                                        |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Jury Duty</b>             | Full pay for up to 15 working days; copy of jury summons required                               |
| <b>Military Leave</b>        | Per applicable federal/state law; pay differential provided for up to 6 months                  |
| <b>Civic / Voting Leave</b>  | Up to 3 hours paid leave to vote on election day if polls are not accessible outside work hours |
| <b>Volunteer Leave</b>       | 2 days paid per year to volunteer with approved charitable organizations                        |
| <b>Study / Exam Leave</b>    | Up to 3 days paid per year for job-related professional exams                                   |
| <b>Sabbatical</b>            | 4-week paid sabbatical available after 7 continuous years of service                            |
| <b>Unpaid Personal Leave</b> | Up to 3 months unpaid, subject to manager and HR approval; benefits may be suspended            |

## 2.6 Leave Request Process

8. Log in to the Workday HR portal ([workday.nexgen.com](https://workday.nexgen.com))
9. Navigate to Time & Absence > Request Absence
10. Select leave type, date range, and add any required notes
11. Attach supporting documentation if required (medical note, jury summons, etc.)
12. Submit — your manager will receive an automated notification for approval
13. You will receive an email confirmation once approved (typically within 2 business days)
14. For emergencies, call your manager directly and follow up in Workday within 24 hours

CHAPTER 03

Travel Policies

Guidelines for safe, efficient, and cost-effective business travel

3.1 Scope & Authorization

This policy applies to all employees traveling on company business, including conferences, client visits, training programs, and internal meetings at other NexGen locations. All business travel requires advance authorization:

- Domestic travel: Manager approval via Concur at least 5 business days prior to departure
- International travel: Manager + VP approval at least 15 business days prior to departure
- Emergency/last-minute travel: Phone approval from manager, followed by Concur submission within 24 hours

3.2 Booking Procedures

All business travel must be booked through NexGen's approved travel management system, Concur Travel, or through our designated travel agency, GlobalTrav Partners (+1-888-555-0100).

| Transport Type     | Policy                                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Air Travel         | Book economy class for flights under 6 hours. Business class permitted for flights over 6 hours with VP approval.                                   |
| Hotels             | Use preferred hotel partners listed in Concur for best rates. Select mid-range options (≤ \$250/night domestic, ≤ \$350/night international).       |
| Car Rentals        | Book compact or mid-size vehicles. Luxury/SUV class requires manager approval. Always decline the rental company's CDW — NexGen's policy covers it. |
| Rail Travel        | Preferred over short-haul flights when journey time is comparable. Book standard class.                                                             |
| Ride-Share / Taxis | For airport transfers only. Use company Uber for Business account.                                                                                  |

3.3 Per Diem & Expense Allowances

NexGen provides daily meal and incidental allowances based on destination. Receipts are required for all individual expenses over \$25.

| Destination                            | Domestic M&IE | International M&IE |
|----------------------------------------|---------------|--------------------|
| Tier 1 Cities (NYC, SF, London, Tokyo) | \$120 / day   | \$160 / day        |

| Destination                                | Domestic M&IE | International M&IE |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------|--------------------|
| Tier 2 Cities (Chicago, Boston, LA, Paris) | \$95 / day    | \$130 / day        |
| Tier 3 Cities (All other domestic US)      | \$75 / day    | \$100 / day        |
| International (Outside Tier 1–2)           | \$90 / day    | \$120 / day        |

| Expense Category                      | Reimbursement Rule                                                         |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Business Meals (with client/prospect) | Actual cost, up to \$100/person; itemized receipt + attendee list required |
| Team Meals (no client)                | Up to \$35/person; manager approval required                               |
| Tips / Gratuity                       | Up to 20% is reimbursable; included in per diem                            |
| Alcohol                               | Up to \$20/day reimbursable; must be incidental to a business meal         |
| Mini-Bar / Room Service               | Personal expense — not reimbursable                                        |
| Hotel Wi-Fi                           | Reimbursable at actual cost                                                |
| Checked Baggage                       | 1 bag reimbursable for trips ≥ 3 nights                                    |
| Laundry                               | Reimbursable for trips ≥ 5 consecutive nights                              |

3.4 Expense Reimbursement Process

- 15. Collect all receipts during your trip (digital photos via Concur mobile app recommended).
- 16. Submit your expense report in Concur within 10 business days of returning from travel.
- 17. Attach receipts, select appropriate expense categories, and add business purpose notes.
- 18. Your manager reviews and approves expense reports within 5 business days.
- 19. Finance processes approved reports — reimbursement is paid via direct deposit in the next payroll cycle.
- 20. Late submissions (> 30 days) may be denied without exception.

|                                                                                                                              |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  <b>International Travel Checklist</b>    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Passport valid for at least 6 months beyond travel dates                                            |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Visa obtained (check visa requirements at <a href="https://travel.state.gov">travel.state.gov</a> ) |
| <input type="checkbox"/> NexGen travel insurance certificate downloaded (available in Workday)                               |

|                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Emergency contacts registered with GlobalTrav Partners                                  |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Notify your bank and credit card providers of travel dates                              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Download offline maps and translation apps before departure                             |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Review NexGen's country-specific security briefs (see IT Security for VPN requirements) |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Confirm local emergency numbers and nearest NexGen office/contact                       |

3.5 Travel Safety

Employee safety is NexGen's top priority during business travel:

- All employees must register international trips in the GlobalTrav Partners portal for 24/7 emergency assistance.
- NexGen provides travel insurance covering medical emergencies, trip cancellations, and lost luggage — certificate available in Workday.
- For travel to high-risk countries (State Department Level 3–4), additional security briefing and VP approval is required.
- Never travel to Level 4 (Do Not Travel) destinations on company business under any circumstances.
- Report any security incidents or concerns immediately to your manager and HR.

CHAPTER 04

Medical Benefits

Comprehensive coverage for you and your family

NexGen is proud to offer one of the most competitive benefits packages in our industry. All full-time employees working 30+ hours per week are eligible. Benefits are effective on the first day of the month following your hire date.

4.1 Medical Insurance

We offer three medical plan options through BlueCross BlueShield, allowing you to choose the plan that best fits your health needs and budget:

| Plan Feature             | Gold Plan (PPO)                   | Silver Plan (PPO)          | Bronze Plan (HDHP)   |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------|
| Annual Deductible        | \$500 individual / \$1,000 family | \$1,500 / \$3,000          | \$3,000 / \$6,000    |
| Out-of-Pocket Maximum    | \$3,000 / \$6,000                 | \$5,000 / \$10,000         | \$6,500 / \$13,000   |
| Primary Care Copay       | \$20                              | \$30                       | 20% after deductible |
| Specialist Copay         | \$40                              | \$60                       | 25% after deductible |
| Emergency Room           | \$150 (waived if admitted)        | \$250 (waived if admitted) | 20% after deductible |
| Prescription Drugs       | \$10 / \$30 / \$60 (Tiers 1/2/3)  | \$15 / \$45 / \$75         | \$20 / \$60 / \$100  |
| Telehealth Visits        | \$0 copay                         | \$10 copay                 | \$10 copay           |
| Employee Monthly Premium | \$85                              | \$45                       | \$15                 |
| Employee + Spouse        | \$210                             | \$150                      | \$90                 |
| Employee + Children      | \$195                             | \$140                      | \$80                 |
| Family                   | \$310                             | \$240                      | \$160                |



HDHP + HSA Advantage

The Bronze (HDHP) plan qualifies for a Health Savings Account (HSA).

NexGen contributes \$500/year (individual) or \$1,000/year (family) to your HSA.

HSA contributions are tax-free, grow tax-free, and can be used tax-free for qualified medical expenses.

Unused HSA funds roll over indefinitely — it's your money, even if you leave NexGen.

## 4.2 Dental Insurance

| Benefit                                   | Coverage                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Provider                                  | Delta Dental PPO                                            |
| Annual Maximum Benefit                    | \$2,000 per person                                          |
| Deductible                                | \$50 individual / \$150 family (waived for preventive care) |
| Preventive Care (cleanings, X-rays)       | 100% covered in-network                                     |
| Basic Restorative (fillings, extractions) | 80% covered after deductible                                |
| Major Restorative (crowns, root canals)   | 60% covered after deductible                                |
| Orthodontics                              | 50% up to \$1,500 lifetime maximum (adults and children)    |
| Implants                                  | 60% covered, subject to annual maximum                      |
| Employee Monthly Premium                  | \$12 / Employee+Spouse \$32 / Family \$48                   |

## 4.3 Vision Insurance

| Benefit                  | Coverage                                        |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Provider                 | VSP Vision Care                                 |
| Eye Exam                 | \$10 copay, once per calendar year              |
| Frames                   | Up to \$180 allowance (every 24 months)         |
| Lenses                   | Fully covered standard lenses (every 12 months) |
| Contact Lenses           | Up to \$180 allowance in lieu of frames/lenses  |
| Laser Vision Correction  | 15% discount at participating providers         |
| Employee Monthly Premium | \$6 / Employee+Spouse \$14 / Family \$20        |

## 4.4 Mental Health & Wellness

NexGen treats mental health with the same priority as physical health. Our comprehensive wellness offering includes:

- Employee Assistance Program (EAP): Up to 8 free confidential counseling sessions per year through LifeWorks (1-800-555-EAP1).
- Mental health visits covered at the same cost-sharing level as primary care visits under all medical plans.
- \$600 annual Wellness Reimbursement Account for gym memberships, fitness apps, meditation apps (e.g., Calm, Headspace), or wellness coaching.
- Mindfulness & resilience workshops offered quarterly through HR.
- Mental Health First Aid–trained managers across all departments.
- Dedicated mental health days: 2 additional paid personal days per year, no questions asked.

## 4.5 Additional Benefits

| Benefit                                | Details                                                                                                              |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Life Insurance</b>                  | 2x annual salary, up to \$500,000 — 100% company paid. Supplemental life available at employee cost.                 |
| <b>Short-Term Disability</b>           | 60% of base salary for up to 12 weeks; begins after 7-day elimination period. 100% company paid.                     |
| <b>Long-Term Disability</b>            | 60% of base salary after STD exhaustion, up to Social Security Normal Retirement Age. 100% company paid.             |
| <b>Flexible Spending Account (FSA)</b> | Up to \$3,050/year pre-tax for medical; up to \$5,000/year for dependent care FSA.                                   |
| <b>401(k) Retirement Plan</b>          | NexGen matches 100% of first 4% of eligible compensation. Immediate vesting. Traditional and Roth options available. |
| <b>Commuter Benefits</b>               | Up to \$315/month pre-tax for transit or parking.                                                                    |
| <b>Pet Insurance</b>                   | Voluntary group rates through Nationwide Pet Insurance.                                                              |
| <b>Fertility &amp; Family Planning</b> | Up to \$15,000 lifetime benefit for fertility treatments, surrogacy, or adoption assistance.                         |
| <b>Student Loan Assistance</b>         | \$150/month contribution toward student loan principal for up to 5 years.                                            |

## 4.6 Benefits Enrollment

21. New hires must enroll within 30 days of hire date via Workday > Benefits > Open Enrollment.
22. Annual Open Enrollment is held each November for January 1 effective date.
23. Qualifying Life Events (marriage, birth, adoption, divorce) allow changes within 30 days.
24. Contact the Benefits Helpdesk at [benefits@nexgen.com](mailto:benefits@nexgen.com) or Ext. 4050 for assistance.

CHAPTER 05

IT Support Procedures

Getting the technology help you need, when you need it

5.1 Acceptable Use of Technology

Company-owned technology resources — including computers, mobile devices, network access, software, email, and cloud services — are provided for business purposes. Limited, reasonable personal use is permitted provided it does not:

- Interfere with job performance or productivity
- Compromise system security or network performance
- Violate any company policy or applicable law
- Create legal liability for NexGen (e.g., piracy, harassment, defamation)

|  Strictly Prohibited Activities |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Installing unauthorized software, apps, or browser extensions                                                    |
| Accessing, storing, or sharing illegal, obscene, or offensive content                                            |
| Sharing your credentials with anyone, including colleagues or IT staff                                           |
| Bypassing security controls, firewalls, or encryption                                                            |
| Using company systems to mine cryptocurrency                                                                     |
| Connecting unauthorized personal devices to the corporate network                                                |

5.2 IT Help Desk — Contacting Support

| Contact Method      | Details                                                         |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| IT Help Desk Portal | helpdesk.nexgen.com — Submit and track tickets 24/7             |
| Phone Support       | Ext. 5000   External: +1-855-555-IT00                           |
| Live Chat           | Available in Microsoft Teams: search 'IT Help Bot'              |
| Email               | it-support@nexgen.com (monitored Mon–Fri, 7 AM–8 PM local time) |
| Walk-In IT Bar      | Building A, Floor 1 — Mon–Fri, 9 AM–5 PM                        |
| P1 Emergency (24/7) | Ext. 5001 — for business-critical outages only                  |



## 5.3 Incident Priority Levels

| Priority             | Definition                                             | SLA                                           |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| <b>P1 — Critical</b> | Business-critical system down, data breach, ransomware | 15-minute response, 2-hour resolution target  |
| <b>P2 — High</b>     | Core business function impaired, team impacted         | 1-hour response, 4-hour resolution target     |
| <b>P3 — Medium</b>   | Single user impacted, workaround available             | 4-hour response, next business day resolution |
| <b>P4 — Low</b>      | Minor issue, cosmetic, how-to question                 | 8-hour response, 3 business day resolution    |

## 5.4 Standard IT Services

The following services are available to all employees through the IT Help Desk portal:

| Service                                    | How to Access                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Password Reset</b>                      | Self-service at <a href="https://account.nexgen.com">account.nexgen.com</a> or call Ext. 5000                                         |
| <b>New Software Request</b>                | Submit via <a href="https://helpdesk.nexgen.com">helpdesk.nexgen.com</a> with business justification; 5-business-day approval process |
| <b>Hardware Request / Replacement</b>      | Submit ticket; standard equipment ships within 3 business days; damage assessment required for replacements                           |
| <b>VPN Access</b>                          | Configured on all company laptops; request credentials via helpdesk if not active                                                     |
| <b>Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)</b>   | Mandatory for all accounts; set up via <a href="https://account.nexgen.com/mfa">account.nexgen.com/mfa</a>                            |
| <b>Email Distribution Lists</b>            | Request creation/modification via helpdesk ticket                                                                                     |
| <b>New Employee Onboarding Setup</b>       | Managed by IT Onboarding team; equipment provisioned before Day 1                                                                     |
| <b>Cloud Storage (OneDrive/SharePoint)</b> | 1 TB OneDrive per user; SharePoint site requests via helpdesk                                                                         |
| <b>Video Conferencing (Teams/Zoom)</b>     | Pro licenses for all employees; webinar licenses on request                                                                           |
| <b>Mobile Device Management</b>            | Company-approved apps pushed to enrolled devices via Intune                                                                           |

## 5.5 Equipment Policy

NexGen provides every employee with the standard equipment required to perform their role effectively. Standard kit includes:

- Laptop (MacBook Pro 14" or Dell XPS 15", based on role) with pre-installed software suite
- External monitor (27" 4K) for office-based and hybrid employees
- Ergonomic keyboard, mouse, and headset
- Mobile phone for roles requiring mobile access (Sales, Field, Management)

Employees are responsible for the safekeeping of assigned equipment. Lost or damaged equipment due to negligence may result in partial cost recovery. All equipment must be returned within 5 business days of separation from the company.

## 5.6 Remote Work Tech Support

Remote and hybrid employees receive the same IT support as office employees. Additional remote-specific provisions:

- \$500 one-time home office stipend for peripheral equipment (claimable via Concur > Other Expenses > Home Office Setup)
- \$50/month internet connectivity stipend for fully remote employees (submit via Workday)
- All remote connections must use the NexGen VPN (GlobalProtect). Contact IT to install.
- Remote employees may borrow from the equipment loan pool for temporary needs — request via helpdesk.

CHAPTER 06

Security Guidelines

Protecting our people, data, and systems

Information security is everyone's responsibility at NexGen. A single security breach can compromise client trust, expose sensitive data, and cause significant financial and reputational damage. These guidelines are mandatory — not optional.

6.1 Password & Authentication Standards

| Requirement                       | Standard                                                         |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Minimum Length                    | 14 characters                                                    |
| Complexity                        | Must include uppercase, lowercase, number, and special character |
| Rotation                          | Every 90 days; last 10 passwords cannot be reused                |
| Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) | Mandatory for all systems, no exceptions                         |
| Password Manager                  | NexGen-licensed 1Password available for all employees            |
| Shared Accounts                   | Strictly prohibited. Every user must have their own credentials. |
| Default Passwords                 | Must be changed immediately upon first login to any system       |

6.2 Data Classification & Handling

| Classification | Examples                                                | Handling Requirements                                              |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Public         | Marketing materials, press releases, published content  | May be freely shared externally                                    |
| Internal       | Policies, procedures, internal communications           | Share only with NexGen employees                                   |
| Confidential   | Financial data, HR records, contracts, strategy docs    | Need-to-know basis; encrypt in transit                             |
| Restricted     | PII, passwords, health data, source code, trade secrets | Encrypt at rest and in transit; access logged; strict need-to-know |

- Never store Restricted data on personal devices, personal cloud storage (Dropbox, personal Google Drive), or USB drives.

- All emails containing Confidential or Restricted data must be encrypted using Microsoft Purview Information Protection.
- Physical documents containing Confidential or Restricted data must be shredded using the office cross-cut shredders — never placed in regular trash or recycling.

6.3 Phishing & Social Engineering Awareness

Phishing is the #1 cause of data breaches globally. Learn to recognize and report suspicious communications:

| Red Flag                               | What to Do                                                                                                                    |
|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Check the sender                       | Hover over sender name to reveal actual email address. Subtle misspellings are common (nexqen.com vs nexgen.com).             |
| Beware of urgency                      | Attackers create false urgency: 'Act NOW or your account is locked.' Legitimate systems do not pressure you this way.         |
| Verify links before clicking           | Hover over links to preview the destination URL. Never click links in unexpected emails.                                      |
| Never enter credentials via email link | Always navigate to sites directly via your browser.                                                                           |
| Suspicious attachments                 | Never open unexpected attachments, especially .exe, .zip, .docm, or password-protected files.                                 |
| Verify phone requests                  | If someone calls claiming to be IT or HR and requests credentials, hang up and call back using the official directory number. |

|                                                                                                                        |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  <b>Report Phishing Immediately</b> |
| If you receive a suspicious email: Click the 'Report Phishing' button in Outlook (PhishAlarm plug-in).                 |
| If you accidentally clicked a phishing link or entered credentials: Call IT Security immediately at Ext. 5001.         |
| Do NOT forward suspicious emails to colleagues or attempt to investigate them yourself.                                |
| We run quarterly phishing simulations — treat all suspicious emails as real threats.                                   |

6.4 Physical Security

- Always wear your NexGen ID badge visibly when on company premises. Badges are required to access all secure areas.
- Do not allow anyone to tailgate through secured doors — even if you recognize them. Politely direct unescorted visitors to reception.
- Visitors must sign in at reception, be issued a visitor badge, and be escorted at all times in secure areas.

- Lock your workstation screen whenever you leave your desk (Windows: Win+L; Mac: Cmd+Ctrl+Q).
- Follow the Clean Desk Policy: lock away or shred sensitive documents at end of each workday.
- Report lost or stolen access badges to Security immediately at Ext. 5100. Do not wait.
- Security cameras are in operation in all common areas, entrances, and data centers.

6.5 Incident Reporting

Report any actual or suspected security incident immediately. Early reporting dramatically limits damage.

| Incident Type                 | How to Report                                                | When                       |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Data Breach / Loss            | Ext. 5001 (24/7) + security@nexgen.com                       | Immediate — do not wait    |
| Ransomware / Malware          | Ext. 5001 (24/7); disconnect device from network immediately | Immediate                  |
| Lost / Stolen Device          | Ext. 5001 + manager                                          | Within 1 hour of discovery |
| Unauthorized Access           | security@nexgen.com                                          | Within 4 hours             |
| Phishing Email                | Report Phishing button in Outlook                            | Immediately upon receipt   |
| Suspicious Person on Premises | Reception or Security desk                                   | Immediately                |

|  Security Quick Reference |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| IT Security 24/7 Hotline: Ext. 5001   External: +1-855-555-SEC0                                              |
| Security Email: security@nexgen.com                                                                          |
| Lost Badge: Security Desk — Building A Lobby   Ext. 5100                                                     |
| Report Phishing: PhishAlarm button in Outlook                                                                |
| Security Policy Portal: security.nexgen.com (full policy library)                                            |

CHAPTER 07

Employee Onboarding Guide

Your roadmap for a strong start at NexGen

7.1 Before Your First Day

Congratulations on your new role! Here's what to expect before Day 1:

| Action                   | What Happens                                                                                   |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Offer Letter & Contracts | DocuSign packet sent to your personal email — sign within 5 days                               |
| Background Check         | Sterling background check link sent by HR — complete within 48 hours                           |
| Equipment Selection      | IT will email you a hardware preference form — respond within 3 days                           |
| Welcome Package          | Digital welcome kit emailed 1 week before start date (logins sent separately)                  |
| Workday Self-Service     | Activate your Workday account to complete new-hire paperwork and benefits enrollment           |
| Parking / Access         | HR will coordinate badge pickup and parking permit. Confirm your start time with your manager. |

7.2 Your First Week — Day-by-Day

| Timeline | Theme                          | Key Activities                                                                                                                                                                         |
|----------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Day 1    | Welcome & Orientation          | 8:30 AM check-in at Reception (Building A). 9 AM NexGen Orientation with HR. Lunch with your manager. IT setup (laptop, accounts, badges). Tour of your workspace and facilities.      |
| Day 2    | Systems & Tools                | Complete IT security training (1.5 hrs, mandatory). Access provisioning for core systems. Meet your immediate team. Review your role overview and 30-60-90 day plan with your manager. |
| Day 3    | Cross-Functional Introductions | Scheduled 1:1s with key stakeholders. Shadow a team colleague. Review departmental                                                                                                     |

| Timeline | Theme                 | Key Activities                                                                                                                            |
|----------|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|          |                       | processes and documentation. HR check-in call.                                                                                            |
| Day 4    | Deep Dive             | Dive into your first project or assignment. Attend team stand-up/meetings. Access the NexGen Learning Hub for mandatory training courses. |
| Day 5    | Reflection & Feedback | End-of-week debrief with your manager. Confirm 30-60-90 day goals. Ask questions. Identify resources you still need.                      |

7.3 Mandatory Training (First 30 Days)

All new employees must complete the following mandatory training courses in the NexGen Learning Hub ([learn.nexgen.com](https://learn.nexgen.com)) within 30 days of start:

| Course Name                                 | Duration   |
|---------------------------------------------|------------|
| Code of Conduct & Ethics                    | 30 minutes |
| Information Security Fundamentals           | 45 minutes |
| Anti-Harassment & Discrimination Prevention | 60 minutes |
| Data Privacy & GDPR Awareness               | 30 minutes |
| Health & Safety in the Workplace            | 20 minutes |
| Diversity, Equity & Inclusion at NexGen     | 45 minutes |
| NexGen Products & Services Overview         | 60 minutes |
| Using Workday & Core HR Systems             | 30 minutes |

|                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  <b>Your 30-60-90 Day Plan</b>                                                       |
| Day 1–30 (Learn): Complete all mandatory training. Understand your team's goals and workflows. Build relationships with key colleagues and stakeholders.                |
| Day 31–60 (Contribute): Begin active contribution to your primary projects. Attend department meetings and add your perspective. Schedule your 60-day check-in with HR. |

Day 61–90 (Grow): Take ownership of a deliverable or workstream. Identify areas for development. Set long-term goals with your manager ahead of the formal 90-day review.

7.4 Key Systems & Access

| System              | URL                  | Purpose                               |
|---------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Workday             | workday.nexgen.com   | HR, payroll, benefits, time-off       |
| Microsoft 365       | portal.office.com    | Email, Teams, Word, Excel, SharePoint |
| Concur              | nexgen.concur.com    | Travel booking, expense reports       |
| NexGen Learning Hub | learn.nexgen.com     | Training courses, certifications      |
| IT Help Desk        | helpdesk.nexgen.com  | Tech support, software requests       |
| 1Password           | nexgen.1password.com | Enterprise password manager           |
| NexGen Intranet     | intranet.nexgen.com  | News, policies, org charts, directory |
| Okta SSO            | nexgen.okta.com      | Single sign-on portal for all apps    |

7.5 Your NexGen Support Network

| Contact             | Role                                                                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Your Manager        | Primary point of contact for role clarity, priorities, and day-to-day support |
| HR Business Partner | Partner for career development, policy questions, and employee relations      |
| Onboarding Buddy    | A peer colleague assigned to help you settle in. Meet them on Day 2.          |
| IT Help Desk        | Tech setup, access issues, software requests                                  |
| Benefits Team       | Medical, dental, vision, 401(k) and wellness questions                        |
| Payroll Team        | Pay statements, tax forms, direct deposit setup                               |



## CHAPTER 08

# Frequently Asked Questions

*Quick answers to common questions*

## 8.1 Payroll & Compensation

| Question                                   | Answer                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>When do I get paid?</b>                 | NexGen pays bi-weekly on Fridays. The pay schedule for the year is available on the intranet under Payroll > Pay Calendar.                                                     |
| <b>How do I set up direct deposit?</b>     | Log in to Workday > Pay > Payment Elections. Changes take effect within 2 pay cycles.                                                                                          |
| <b>How do I access my pay stubs?</b>       | Workday > Pay > Pay Slips. All historical pay stubs are stored there indefinitely.                                                                                             |
| <b>How do I update my tax withholding?</b> | Workday > Pay > Tax Elections. You can also submit a new W-4/state equivalent form to payroll@nexgen.com.                                                                      |
| <b>What is the merit increase cycle?</b>   | Merit increases are effective April 1 annually, based on your Q4 performance rating. Increases range from 0–8% based on performance and market benchmarks.                     |
| <b>How does the bonus work?</b>            | Annual bonuses are paid in March. Target bonus is 10–20% of base salary (varies by level). Prorated for partial-year employees. Requires active employment on the payout date. |

## 8.2 HR & Employment

| Question                                                   | Answer                                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>What is my probationary period?</b>                     | All new employees have a 90-day probationary period. Your first formal performance check-in occurs at Day 90.                                |
| <b>How do I request an employment verification letter?</b> | Email hr@nexgen.com with 'Verification Letter Request' in the subject. Allow 3 business days.                                                |
| <b>What is the notice period?</b>                          | Individual contributors: 2 weeks. Managers and Seniors: 4 weeks. Directors and above: 6 weeks. See your offer letter for any specific terms. |
| <b>How do I update my personal information?</b>            | Log in to Workday > Personal Information. You can update your address, emergency contacts, and personal details there.                       |
| <b>Can I have a side job?</b>                              | Side employment is permitted provided it does not create a conflict of interest with NexGen business. Disclose any potential                 |

| Question                                        | Answer                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                 | conflicts in writing to HR.                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>How do I apply for an internal transfer?</b> | Speak with your manager first, then check open roles on the intranet. You must have been in your current role for at least 12 months unless your manager grants an exception. |

### 8.3 Benefits & Leave

| Question                                             | Answer                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>When do my benefits start?</b>                    | Benefits are effective the first day of the month following your hire date (e.g., hired March 15 → benefits effective April 1).                                                             |
| <b>What if I miss open enrollment?</b>               | You must wait until the next open enrollment period unless you experience a Qualifying Life Event (marriage, birth, loss of other coverage).                                                |
| <b>Can I change my 401(k) contribution anytime?</b>  | Yes. Log in to Fidelity NetBenefits at <a href="https://netbenefits.com">netbenefits.com</a> . Changes take effect in the next payroll cycle.                                               |
| <b>Is my domestic partner covered under medical?</b> | Yes. Qualified domestic partners (same or opposite sex) are eligible for coverage. Additional imputed income tax may apply.                                                                 |
| <b>How do I access the EAP?</b>                      | Call LifeWorks at 1-800-555-EAP1, or visit <a href="https://lifeworks.com/nexgen">lifeworks.com/nexgen</a> . Completely confidential — NexGen does not receive any identifying information. |
| <b>Can I cash out unused vacation?</b>               | NexGen does not offer vacation cash-out except upon separation. Accrued, unused vacation is paid in your final paycheck.                                                                    |

### 8.4 Workplace & Office

| Question                                | Answer                                                                                                                                                |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>What are the core working hours?</b> | Core hours are 10 AM – 3 PM local time. Outside core hours, flexible scheduling is available with manager agreement.                                  |
| <b>Is there a dress code?</b>           | Business casual in the office. Client-facing meetings may require business professional attire. Use good judgment and ask your manager when in doubt. |
| <b>Where do I park?</b>                 | Employee parking is in the adjacent parking structure. Register your vehicle via the Facilities portal on the intranet. Monthly rates are subsidized. |
| <b>What food options are available?</b> | The office cafeteria is open 7 AM – 3 PM weekdays. There are                                                                                          |

| Question                                | Answer                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                         | also vending areas and a fully stocked kitchen on each floor. Coffee and tea are complimentary.                                          |
| <b>Is there a gym on-site?</b>          | Yes — Building B, Floor B1. Access with your badge 24/7. Personal training sessions available at a discounted rate (ask HR for details). |
| <b>How do I book a conference room?</b> | Use the Room Finder in Outlook or the 'Book a Room' link on the intranet. Rooms can be booked up to 4 weeks in advance.                  |

## 8.5 Technology & IT

| Question                                        | Answer                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>I forgot my password — what do I do?</b>     | Go to <a href="https://account.nexgen.com/reset">account.nexgen.com/reset</a> or call the IT Help Desk at Ext. 5000. MFA will be required to verify your identity.                     |
| <b>Can I use my personal device for work?</b>   | Personal devices may access email and Teams via the Outlook and Teams mobile apps. Access to sensitive systems requires company devices or an enrolled personal device via Intune MDM. |
| <b>What software is available for free?</b>     | All Microsoft 365 apps (including 5 personal installs), Zoom, 1Password, Adobe Acrobat, and Slack. See the full list on the IT portal.                                                 |
| <b>How long until my IT ticket is resolved?</b> | Depends on priority. P3 (most common issues) target: next business day. Check your ticket status at <a href="https://helpdesk.nexgen.com">helpdesk.nexgen.com</a> .                    |
| <b>Can I install my own software?</b>           | Personal software that is not business-related is not permitted on company devices. Request business software through the IT Help Desk for review and approval.                        |

## Appendix A — Key Contacts Directory

| Department            | Contact Name        | How to Reach                                                                         |
|-----------------------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| HR Director           | Sandra Okafor       | Ext. 4400   <a href="mailto:sandra.okafor@nexgen.com">sandra.okafor@nexgen.com</a>   |
| HR Helpdesk (General) | HR Team             | Ext. 4000   <a href="mailto:hr@nexgen.com">hr@nexgen.com</a>                         |
| Payroll               | Payroll Team        | <a href="mailto:payroll@nexgen.com">payroll@nexgen.com</a>   Ext. 4200               |
| Benefits              | Benefits Team       | <a href="mailto:benefits@nexgen.com">benefits@nexgen.com</a>   Ext. 4050             |
| IT Help Desk          | IT Support          | Ext. 5000   <a href="mailto:it-support@nexgen.com">it-support@nexgen.com</a>         |
| IT Security (24/7)    | Security Team       | Ext. 5001   <a href="mailto:security@nexgen.com">security@nexgen.com</a>             |
| Facilities            | Facilities Desk     | <a href="mailto:facilities@nexgen.com">facilities@nexgen.com</a>   Ext. 6000         |
| Travel (GlobalTrav)   | GlobalTrav Partners | 1-888-555-0100   24/7 Emergency                                                      |
| EAP (LifeWorks)       | Confidential        | 1-800-555-EAP1   <a href="https://lifeworks.com/nexgen">lifeworks.com/nexgen</a>     |
| Ethics Hotline        | Anonymous           | 1-800-NGS-SAFE   <a href="https://nexgen.ethicspoint.com">nexgen.ethicspoint.com</a> |

## Appendix B — Glossary of Terms

| Term                               | Definition                                                                                                                     |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EAP (Employee Assistance Program)  | A confidential, company-funded program offering counseling, mental health, and life coaching services at no cost to employees. |
| HDHP (High Deductible Health Plan) | A medical plan with a higher deductible and lower premiums that qualifies for use with a Health Savings Account (HSA).         |
| HSA (Health Savings Account)       | A tax-advantaged account for qualified medical expenses, available when enrolled in an HDHP.                                   |

| Term                                      | Definition                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| MFA (Multi-Factor Authentication)         | A security method requiring two or more verification methods to access an account.                                   |
| Open Enrollment                           | The annual period during which employees may enroll in or change benefit elections.                                  |
| PII (Personally Identifiable Information) | Information that can identify a specific individual, such as name, SSN, address, or medical data.                    |
| PTO (Paid Time Off)                       | Paid leave that can be used for vacation, illness, or personal matters.                                              |
| Qualifying Life Event (QLE)               | An event that allows changes to benefit elections outside open enrollment (marriage, birth, loss of coverage, etc.). |
| SLA (Service Level Agreement)             | A commitment to respond to or resolve a request within a specified timeframe.                                        |
| VPN (Virtual Private Network)             | A secure, encrypted connection to the NexGen network used when working remotely.                                     |

## Appendix C — Policy Acknowledgment

By signing below, I acknowledge that I have received, read, and understood the NexGen Solutions Employee Handbook (Version 3.0, Effective January 1, 2025). I understand that this handbook does not constitute a contract of employment and that NexGen reserves the right to modify policies with reasonable notice.

|                            |  |
|----------------------------|--|
| Employee Full Name (Print) |  |
| Employee ID                |  |
| Department                 |  |
| Manager Name               |  |
| Employee Signature         |  |
| Date                       |  |

*Please return a signed copy to HR (hr@nexgen.com or Building A, HR Suite 101) within 5 business days of your start date. A digital copy will also be sent via DocuSign.*